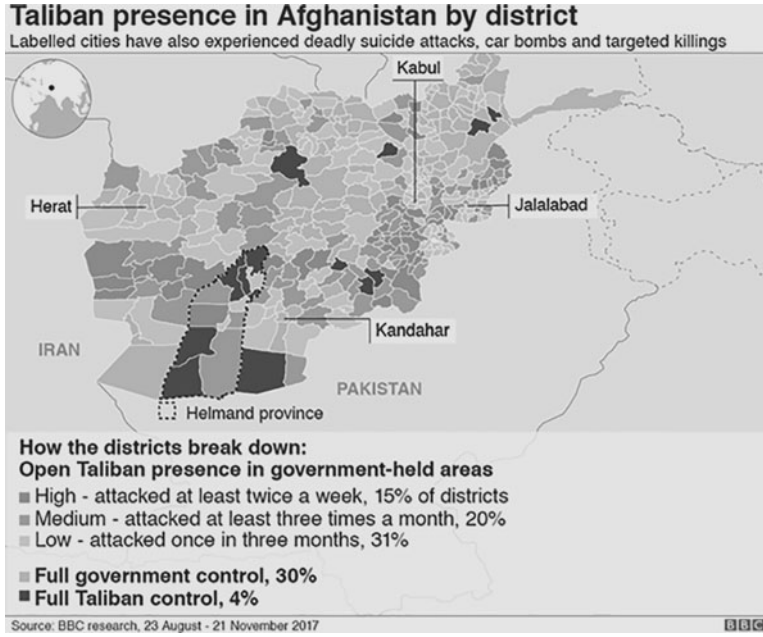


Map 4.1 Taliban-controlled areas in Afghanistan.

its scribe that Mullah Omar travelled to Karachi in September 2009 and inaugurated a new senior leadership council there. The officials alleged that Pakistan's Inter-Services Intelligence agency, ISI, helped the Taliban leaders move from Quetta, where they were exposed to attacks by unmanned US drones. Bruce Riedel, CIA veteran and analyst on Al Qaeda and the Taliban, confirmed that Mullah Omar had been spotted in Karachi (*The News International*, 2009).

Interestingly, the Taliban chief Mullah Omar never approved of TTP's activities in Pakistan. He rather asked them to come to Afghanistan for jihad. Conversely, Baitullah Mehsud although considered to be part of Mullah Omar, hardly paid heed to his instructions and concentrated on insurgency in FATA and terrorism in the cities of Pakistan. This dichotomy rebuffed the assertions that the TTP had provided an 'essential rear base for the Taliban insurgency in Afghanistan' (*The New York Times*, 2009). After Baitullah's death, the new TTP Chief Hakimullah continued his policies and could not find favour with the Afghan Taliban (see Map 4.1).